

Salad Turnips

CULTIVARS

- Hakurei

INTENSIVE SPACING

- 6 rows per bed spaced every 2" (5 cm) on the row
- Jang seeder Y-24, 11F-13B, brush "0", =

FERTILIZATION

- Salad turnips will do great in beds that were previously amended with compost and fertilized with a mix of alfalfa meal (2-0-2) and pelleted chicken manure (5-3-2).

IRRIGATION

Irrigation Type

- Drip tape (4 per bed) or sprinkler

Irrigation Management

- Root depth: Shallow (6"-24")
- General: Need adequate moisture – dry soil results in tough, woody turnips, and vulnerability to flea beetles.

IMPLANTATION

For continuous supply of salad turnips, we seed every week with an estimated 30% more than our weekly need. Our spacings will allow for harvest over more than one week, but we usually aim to crop out the beds as we go.

In our system, turnips are seeded alongside radishes, arugula, and other baby Asian greens, all crops that will stay in the field for less than 45 days and that belong to the *brassicaceae* family. They therefore have the same fertilization and plant protection requirements.

EQUIPMENT

- Rotary harrow
- Jang seeder + Y-24 rollers, scale, notepad and your seeds
- 30" rake
- Anti-insect netting (or row cover in the spring)

ITINERARY

- Remove tarp and clean large debris. Use the rake if needed. *
- Uniformly apply amendments and pass with the rotary harrow at a depth of 1.5" (4 cm). Use the rake to remove debris if needed. Otherwise the bed is ready to be seeded.
- Seed using the Jang. Check seeding density by measuring the weight of seeds distributed.
- Cover with anti-insect netting, install irrigation and water the soil until it is deeply moist.

* If the previous crop is too well established, or if the bed is too messy, mow the crop as low as possible and harrow at a depth of 2" (5 cm). Add 1" (2.5 cm) of compost evenly spread on the whole width of the bed and transplant into compost following a no-till strategy.

WEEDING

- Salad turnips are cultivated using the flex tine weeder 12-14 days after direct seeding, or when weeds are at the filament/cotyledon stage. They are cultivated only once, because subsequent weeds won't have enough time to go to seed before the bed is cropped out and turned over.

PLANT PROTECTION

- To protect the crop against flea beetles, immediately cover the bed with anti-insect netting (or row cover) after seeding.
- This practice is even more effective if the seed bed is irrigated right before installing the netting as this will chase away the flea beetles. The more tightly the sides are sealed, the better the results will be.

HARVEST

- Salad turnips are harvested with their tops and bunched in the fields in a kneeling position.
- One person harvests several rows at a time, pulling the largest turnips (or the smallest ones, depending on the growth stage of the crop), bunching only the nicest ones. Only those that are the right size, free of blemishes and without splits are taken.
- We aim to have bunches of +/- 8 turnips of sizes varying from 1.5" to 2" (4 to 5 cm).
- ALWAYS size when bunching. Small turnips are bunched together and large turnips are bunched together.
- Make piles of 5 bunches in the aisles. When there are quite a few piles on the ground, someone picks them up and counts them into harvest totes.
- 1 person should harvest 65-80 bunches per hour.

CONDITIONING

- Upon arriving from the fields, the harvest crates are placed to the left of the sinks. The bunches are washed with a pressure gun one by one and piled on the right. Once the pile has reached a certain height, place bunches in storage bin and identify the bin.
- 1 person should wash and package at least 100 bunches per hour.

STORING

- Salad turnips are stored in cold room kept at 35 °F (2 °C)